Shahab Zaki Pour, Ph.D.
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U.S. Permanent Resident

Professional Summary

Virologist and computational biologist with expertise in viral genomics, host-pathogen interactions, next-generation sequencing (NGS), transcriptomics, and bioinformatics. Experienced in RNA-seq, viral phylogenetics, and high-performance computing to investigate viral evolution and immune responses

Education

Postdoctoral fellowship, School of Medicine Division of Pediatrics, Emory University, Atlanta, Georgia, U.S. *2024 - 2026*
Project: Role of CD8+ T cells in HIV reservoir establishment and maintenance

Ph.D., Biological Science (Microbiology), University of Sao Paulo, Brazil *2018 - 2023*
Laboratory: Laboratory of Molecular Evolution & Bioinformatics (LEMB), Department of Microbiology
Doctoral Dissertation: Comparative post-mortem liver-specific gene expression and transcriptome Response in wild-type and vaccine adverse reactions of yellow fever
Supervisor: Prof. Paolo Marinho de Andrade Zanotto, D.Phil.
GPA: 3.72/4.0

MSc., Biological Science (Microbiology), University of Sao Paulo, Brazil *2015 - 2018*
Laboratory: Laboratory of Molecular Evolution & Bioinformatics (LEMEB), Department of Microbiology
Master's Thesis: Development and validation of an in-house method for whole genome amplification and sequencing of Zika virus
Supervisor: Prof. Paolo Marinho de Andrade Zanotto, D.Phil.
GPA: 3.29/4.0

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant
Course: BMM0586 - Virology
Instructors: Prof. Dr. Enrique Mario Boccardo Pierulivo, Prof. Dr. Patrícia Cristina Baleeiro Beltrao Braga.
Institution: University of Sao Paulo, Department of Microbiology (ICBII-USP), Spring 2020

- Assisted in preparing and running weekly laboratory practical for ~55 undergraduate students in Biomedical Sciences, covering viral detection, quantification, and molecular characterization
- Guided students through qPCR, RT-qPCR, and NGS-based workflows, drawing on concurrent doctoral research in arbovirus genomic surveillance

- Led discussion sessions linking lecture content to current research problems in viral pathogenesis and outbreak response
- Provided written feedback on laboratory reports and supported students with computational components of the course

Mentorship

Viviane de Fatima Benedetti - Master's Student, Laboratory of Molecular Evolution & Bioinformatics, University of Sao Paulo

Project: Molecular epidemiology of arboviral infections in clinical samples, Western Bahia, Brazil

- Trained mentee in RNA extraction, qRT-PCR diagnostics, serotyping, sequencing workflows, and phylogenetic analysis; transitioned to advisory role as mentee gained independence in experimental design and bioinformatics
- Mentee's contributions published in *Co-circulation of Chikungunya virus, Zika virus, and serotype 1 of Dengue virus in Western Bahia, Brazil*, Frontiers in Microbiology, 2023 (DOI: 10.3389/fmicb.2023.1240860). Mentee held her own CNPq fellowship (grant no. 132611/2020-1) during the project

Hugo Valério Corrêa de Oliveira, Ph.D. - Sabbatical Postdoctoral Researcher *(2021-2022)*, Laboratory of Molecular Evolution & Bioinformatics, University of Sao Paulo

Home institution: Associate Professor, Escola Superior de Ciências da Saúde (ESA), Universidade do Estado do Amazonas (UEA), Manaus, Brazil

Project: Viral metagenomics of freshwater and wastewater systems, Sao Paulo metropolitan region

- Introduced mentee to viral metagenomics pipeline (Kraken2, Bracken, Kaiju, MetaSPAdes, PROKKA); collaborated on analytical design and interpretation of virome ecology data across environmental and public health contexts
- Mentee first-authored manuscript *Comparative Metagenomics of DNA Virus Communities Along an Anthropogenic Gradient in the São Paulo Metropolitan Region*, currently under peer review at Access Microbiology (Microbiology Society) (DOI: 10.1099/acmi.0.001272.v1)

Research Experience

Postdoctoral Researcher Fellowship *2024 - 2026*
Emory University School of Medicine, Department of Pediatrics

- Designed and executed **in vivo CD8$^+$ T-cell depletion experiments in ART-treated infant rhesus macaques**, identifying immune mechanisms contributing to **viral reservoir maintenance in pediatric HIV infection**
- Applied **high-dimensional flow cytometry, barcoded SIV sequencing, and IPDA** to characterize virus-host interactions, generating datasets supporting **immune-based HIV cure strategies**
- Quantified viral reservoirs using **intact proviral DNA assay and integration site analysis**, contributing to **ongoing NIH-funded studies on pediatric HIV persistence**
- Collaborated with a multidisciplinary team across virology, systems immunology, bioinformatics, and mathematical modeling

Ph.D Researcher *2018 - 2023*
Department of Microbiology, University of Sao Paulo, Brazil

- Investigated host-pathogen interactions during severe Yellow Fever virus infection using integrative transcriptomic approaches
- Generated and analyzed RNA-seq datasets from clinical samples, identifying immune pathways associated with lethal disease outcomes
- Developed bioinformatics pipelines for transcriptomic analysis, including quality control, alignment, differential expression analysis, and pathway enrichment
- Performed systems-level analysis of host immune responses, revealing dysregulated inflammatory and interferon pathways linked to disease severity
- Integrated clinical metadata with transcriptomic data to identify molecular signatures associated with fatal infection
- Contributed to peer-reviewed publications on viral pathogenesis and host immune responses

M.Sc. Researcher *2015 - 2018*
Department of Microbiology, University of Sao Paulo, Brazil

- Developed a cost-effective whole-genome amplification protocol for Zika virus, enabling sequencing directly from clinical samples
- Generated complete viral genomes using next-generation sequencing, supporting genomic surveillance of emerging arboviruses
- Conducted phylogenetic analyses to investigate viral diversity and transmission dynamics during outbreaks
- Implemented bioinformatics workflows for viral genome assembly and annotation
- Contributed genomic data to support molecular epidemiology and outbreak investigations

Publications (Peer-reviewed)

1) Pathogenesis of Pulmonary Complications in Fatal Yellow Fever, Brazil, 2017-2019
Amaro N. Duarte-Neto, Katia C. Dantas, Suzette C. Ferreira, Fernando R. Giugni, Marielton P. Cunha, ***Shahab Z. Pour****, …*
Emerging infectious diseases - 2026, DOI: https://doi.org/10.3201/eid3202.250530

2) COVID-19 vaccination atlas: an integrative systems vaccinology approach
Wasim Aluísio Prates-Syed, Dennyson Leandro Mathias da Fonseca, ***Shahab Zaki Pour****, ...*
Science Translational Medicine - 2025, DOI: https://doi.org/10.1038/s41541-025-01148-3

3) Immunological signatures unveiled by integrative systems vaccinology characterization of dengue vaccination trials and natural infection
*Desirée Rodrigues Placa, Dennyson Leandro M. Fonseca, Alexandre H. C. Marques****, Shahab Zaki Pour,*** *...*
Frontiers in Immunology - 2024, DOI: https://doi.org/10.3389/fimmu.2024.1282754

4) Evaluation of renal markers and liver enzymes in patients infected with the Chikungunya virus
Anderson Pereira Soares, Daniel Ferreira de Lima Neto, ***Shahab Zaki Pour****, ...*
Journal of Medical Virology - 2023, DOI: https://doi.org/10.1002/jmv.29276

5) Understanding yellow fever-associated myocardial injury: an autopsy study

*Fernando Rabioglio Giugni, Vera Demarchi Aiello, Caroline Silverio Faria, **Shahab Zaki Pour**, ...*
e BioMedicine - The Lancet - 2023, DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ebiom.2023.104810

6) **Co-circulation of Chikungunya virus, Zika virus, and serotype 1 of Dengue virus in Western Bahia, Brazil**
*Marcus Vinicius De França Cirilo†, **Shahab Zaki Pour**†, ...*
† These authors share the first authorship
Frontiers - 2023, DOI: https://doi.org/10.3389/fmicb.2023.1240860

7) **Severe COVID-19 patients exhibit elevated levels of autoantibodies targeting cardiolipin and platelet glycoprotein with age: a systems biology approach**
*Dennyson Leandro M Fonseca1, Igor Salerno Filgueiras, Alexandre HC Marques, Elroy Vojdan, Gilad Halpert, Yuri Ostrinski, Gabriela Crispim Baiocchi, Desirée Rodrigues Plaça, Paula P. Freire, **Shahab Zaki Pour**, ...*
NPJAMD - npj aging -2023, DOI: https://doi.org/10.1038/s41514-023-00118-0

8) **Phylogeographic patterns of the yellow fever virus around the metropolitan region of Sao Paulo, Brazil, 2016-2019**
*Marielton dos Passos Cunha, Amaro Nunes Duarte-Neto, **Shahab Zaki Pour,** ...*
PLOS Neglected Tropical Diseases - 2022, DOI: https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pntd.0010705

9) **Chikungunya Virus E2 Structural Protein B-Cell Epitopes Analysis**
*Joao Paulo da Cruz Silva, Marielton dos Passos Cunha, **Zaki Pour, Shahab**, ...*
MDPI - Viruses - 2022, DOI: https://doi.org/10.3390/v14081839

10) **The impact of Zika virus exposure on the placental proteomic profile**
*Livia Rosa-Fernandes, Carla Bandeira, **Shahab Zaki Pour**, ...*
BBA - Molecular Basis of Disease - 2021, DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.bbadis.2021.166270

11) **Systemic dengue infection associated with a new dengue virus type 2 introduction in Brazil - a case report**
*Cunha, Marielton Dos Passos, Duarte-Neto, Amaro Nune, **Zaki Pour, Shahab,** ...*
BMC Infectious Diseases - 2021, DOI: https://doi.org/10.1186/s12879-021-05959-2

12) **Yellow Fever and Orthotopic Liver Transplantation: new insights from the autopsy room for an old but reemerging disease**
*Duarte neto, Amaro Nunes, Cunha, Marielton Dos Passo, Marcilio, Izabel, Song, Alice Tung Wa, De Martino, Rodrigo Bronze, Ho, Yeh li, **Zaki Pour, Shahab,** ...*
Histopathology - 2019, DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/his.13904

13) **Ultrasound-guided minimally invasive autopsy as a tool for rapid post-mortem diagnosis in the 2018 Sao Paulo yellow fever epidemic: Correlation with conventional autopsy**
*Duarte-Neto, Amaro Nunes, Monteiro, Renata Aparecida de Almeida, Johnsson, Janaina, Cunha, Marielton Dos Passos, **Zaki Pour, Shahab,** ...*
PLOS Neglected Tropical Diseases - 2019, DOI: https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pntd.0007625

14) **Origin of the Sao Paulo Yellow Fever epidemic of 2017-2018 revealed through molecular epidemiological analysis of fatal cases**
*Cunha, Marielton Dos Passos, Duarte-Neto, Amaro Nunes, **Zaki Pour, Shahab,** ...*
Scientific Reports - 2019, DOI: https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-019-56650-1

15) **An Outbreak of Human Parvovirus B19 Hidden by Dengue Fever**

*Di Paola Nicholas, Mesquita Flávio, Oliveira Danielle Bruna Leal, De Villabona-Arenas Christian Julián, **Zaki Pour Shahab,** ...*
Clinical Infectious Diseases - 2018, DOI: https://doi.org/10.1093/cid/ciy630

16) **Outbreak of chikungunya virus in a vulnerable population of Sergipe, Brazil: molecular and serological survey**

*Cunha, Marielton Dos Passos, Santos, Cliomar Alves Dos, Neto, Daniel Ferreira De Lima, Schanoski Alessandra Soares, **Zaki Pour, Shahab,** ...*
Journal of Clinical Virology - 2017, DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jcv.2017.10.015

Manuscripts Under Review (Preprints)

1) **Comparative Metagenomics of DNA Virus Communities Along an Anthropogenic Gradient in the São Paulo Metropolitan Region**

*Hugo Valério Corrêa de Oliveira, Elisabeth Mendes Martins de Moura, Telma Alves Monezi, **Shahab Zaki Pour**, ...*
Access Microbiology - 2026, DOI: https://doi.org/10.1099/acmi.0.001272.v1

Grants/Funding

- ZIKA Virus Genomics in Senegal, Cape Verde, and Brazil, Grant Amount: €55.000,00*, 2016 - 2019*

Scholarships, Honors, and Awards

- Doctoral full scholarship - Brazilian Coordination for the Improvement of Higher Education Personnel (CAPES), 2018-2023
- Master's full scholarship - Brazilian Coordination for the Improvement of Higher Education Personnel (CAPES), 2015-2018

Research interests

Microbiology, Virology, Bioinformatics, Next-generation sequencing, Omics, Molecular Evolution, Zoonotic diseases, Viral Surveillance, Molecular Biology, Genetics

Oral and Poster Presentation

Oral

- Role of CD8+ T cells in HIV/SIV on reservoir maintenance in infants, The Center for Childhood Infections and Vaccines (CCIV), Weekly seminar series, Emory University, 2026
- Rapid-Fire in the 7th Annual Pediatric Early Career Research Conference, Emory University, Atlanta, Georgia, *2025,* Invited Speaker
- Beyond Zika - A Tripartite Initiative USP/ Institute Pasteur/ FioCruz, Workshop, Sao Paulo - Brazil, *2016,* Invited Speaker

Poster

- **9th Annual Symposium Center for childhood infections and Vaccines,** Emory University, Atlanta, Georgia - November 6, 2025

Poster: *Experimental CD8 cell depletion induces viral reactivation in ART-suppressed SIV-infected rhesus macaque infants*
Authors*: Shahab Zaki Pour, …*

- **42nd Annual Symposium on Nonhuman Primate Models for AIDS**, Memorial Union, University of Wisconsin-Madison - *September 30 - October 3, 2025*
  Poster: *Experimental CD8 cell depletion induces viral reactivation in ART-suppressed SIV-infected rhesus macaque infants*
  Authors: *Alora Colvin, **Shahab Zaki Pour**, …*

- **7th Annual Pediatric Early Career Researcher Conference**, Emory University, Atlanta, Georgia - *September 9, 2015*
  Poster: *Experimental CD8 cell depletion in ART-suppressed SIV-infected rhesus macaque infants to define the role of CD8+ T cells in pediatric HIV reservoir maintenance*
  Authors: *Shahab Zaki Pour, …*

- **14th Annual Southeastern Pediatric Research Conference**, Atlanta, Georgia - *June 6, 2025*
  Poster*: Experimental CD8 cell depletion in ART-suppressed SIV-infected rhesus macaque infants to define the role of CD8+ T cells in pediatric HIV reservoir maintenance*
  Authors: *Shahab Zaki Pour, …*
- **XXIX Brazilian Congress of Virology & XIII Mercosur Meeting of Virology**, Gramado, Brazil - *October 21, 2018*
  Poster: *Yellow Fever Virus does not infect human fetus? Case report about fatal Yellow Fever Virus infection in a pregnant woman*
  Authors: *Marielton dos Passos Cunha, Amaro Nunes Duarte Neto, Jiri Cerny, **Shahab Zaki Pour**, …*
- **XXIX Brazilian Congress of Virology & XIII Mercosur Meeting of Virology**, Gramado, Brazil - *October 21, 2018*
  Poster: *Yellow fever virus in Sao Paulo, Brazil, 2018: early biological findings*
  Authors*: Marielton dos Passos Cunha, Amaro Nunes Duarte Neto, **Shahab Zaki Pour**, …*

- **XXVIII Brazilian Congress of Virology & XII Mercosur Meeting of Virology**, Belo Horizonte, MG, Brazil - *September 6-10, 2017*
  Poster: *Outbreak of Chikungunya Virus in a vulnerable population of Sergipe, Brazil*
  Authors: *Marielton dos Passos Cunha, Cliomar Alves dos Santos, Daniel Ferreira de Lima Neto, Alessandra Soares Schanoski, **Shahab Zaki Pour**, ...*

- **XXIX Brazilian Congress of Virology & XIII Mercosur Meeting of Virology**, Gramado, RS, Brazil - *October 17-21, 2018*
  Poster: *Molecular detection of Chikungunya virus in urine samples of patients with acute infection in Brazil*
  Authors: *Isabelle Sthefanie Veloso Bonanato, Telma Alves Monezi, Marielton dos Passos Cunha, **Shahab Zaki Pour**, …*

- **20º Congresso Brasileiro de Bioinformática: X-Meeting 2024**, Brazil - *June 11-14, 2024*
  Poster: *Neurologic syndrome without virus replication revealed in post-mortem brain tissue systems analysis in patients with death associated with Yellow Fever Virus*

  Authors: *Barbara Brito, Marielton P. Cunha, **Shahab Zaki Pour**, …*

- **20º Congresso Brasileiro de Bioinformática: X-Meeting 2024,** Brazil - *June 11-14, 2024*
  Poster: *COVID-19 vaccination atlas: a systems vaccinology integrative analysis*
  Authors: *Wasim Aluísio Prates Syed, Dennyson Leandro Mathias da Fonseca, **Shahab Zaki Pour**, ...*

- **ICGEB Congress**, Italy -*September 2024*
  Poster: *Metagenomic analyses from tumor tissues from fibropapillomatosis-afflicted green turtles (Chelonia mydas) captured off the Brazilian coast*
  Authors: *Telma Alves Monezi,* ***Shahab Zaki Pour****, …*

- **I Workshop on Arbovirus Research**, Instituto Carlos Chagas / Fiocruz-PR, Curitiba, Paraná, Brazil - *November 8-9, 2018*

- **XLV Annual Meeting of the Brazilian Society of Immunology**, online - *September 26-28, 2021,* **Poster**: Integrative transcriptomic analysis of exhaustion-associated genes in COVID-19
  Authors: *Gabriela Crispim Baiocchi, Paula Paccielli Freire, Dennyson Leandro M. Fonseca, Igor Salerno Filgueiras, Desirée Rodrigues Plaça,* ***Shahab Zaki Pour****, …*

Conference Organization

Beyond Zika - A Tripartite Initiative USP/ Institute Pasteur/ FioCruz, Workshop, Sao Paulo - Brazil, *2016*

Reviewer and Editorial Contributions

- Reviewer for the Journal of Frontiers in Immunology Front. Immunol. since 2023

Professional Affiliations

- Member of the World Society for Virology (WSV)

Conferences and Workshops

- Strategic Workshop: Prospective Virology: Strategies to Respond to Health Emergencies - Symposium, *Brazil, 2018*
- USP Lecture: Prospective Mathematical Models on the Use of Vaccines against the Zika Virus - Symposium, B*razil, 2018*
- Science and Innovation: Science in the Fight against Dengue, Zika, and Chikungunya - Symposium, *Brazil, 2017*
- The Zika Virus and Chikungunya Epidemic and Its Global Impact - Symposium, *Brazil, 2016*
- Beyond Zika - A Tripartite Initiative - USP/ Institute Pasteur/ FioCruz - Workshop, *Brazil, 2016*
- Zika Virus Diagnostic Workshop, *Brazil, 2016*

Training and Complementary Education

- Biosafety Training, *2015*, Universidade de Sao Paulo - ICB-USP, *Brazil, 2015,* Credit Hours: 08h
- Beyond Zika - A Tripartite Initiative - USP / Institute Pasteur/ FioCruz, Workshop, *Brazil, 2016*, Credit Hours: 20h
- Zika virus diagnosis, Universidade de Sao Paulo - USP, *Brazil, 2016*, Credit Hours: 30h

- Science and Innovation: Science in the fight against dengue, Zika and chikungunya, ILP, *Brazil, 2017*, Credit Hours: 02h
- Operational Training on Platform 3130X (Applied Biosystems), ICB-USP, *Brazil, 2017*, Credit Hours: 08h
- R Course for Health Science, Universidade de Sao Paulo - USP, *Brazil, 2019*, Credit Hours: 20h
- Biosafety Level Laboratory Training NB3, 2019, Scientific Platform Pasteur - USP, *Brazil, 2019*, Credit Hours: 08h
- School of Proteomics (BRPROT) organized by the BRAZILIAN PROTEOMICS SOCIETY, *Brazil, 2023*, Credit Hours: 30h / *Online*
- 2nd Zoonotic Virus Genomic Surveillance Course, organized by Oswaldo Cruz Foundation, Alexander Von Humboldt, and Federal University of Santa Maria, *2024*, Credit Hours: 30h / *Online*
- Bioinformatics applied to metagenomics: integrative microbial data analysis organized by Mangue and Restinga Ecosystems Research Network (Mare Network), *2024*, Credit Hours: 45h/ *Online*

Technical skills

Molecular Biology & Virology Techniques

- Genomic DNA, plasmid DNA, and RNA isolation and purification
- Conventional PCR, RT-qPCR, qPCR, and digital PCR (dPCR)
- PCR primer design for viral surveillance and amplicon sequencing
- Transfection techniques
- ELISA assays
- Agarose and acrylamide gel electrophoresis
- Sanger sequencing using capillary electrophoresis (Applied Biosystems platforms)

Cell Culture & Virology Methods

- Mammalian and mosquito cell culture (primary cells and established cell lines)
- Virus propagation and titration
- Viral plaque assays
- Virus neutralization assays
- Flow cytometry (e.g., cell viability, surface marker analysis, intracellular staining)
- Development and optimization of cost-effective viral sequencing methods
- Experience working under BSL-2+ and BSL-3 laboratory protocols

Next-Generation Sequencing (NGS)

- Illumina sequencing (MiSeq, NextSeq, HiSeq, NovaSeq)
- Oxford Nanopore sequencing (MinIon)
- Amplicon sequencing & library preparation
- Whole-genome sequencing

Bioinformatics & Omics Data Analysis

- Bulk RNA-seq alignment & quantification (Bowtie2, STAR, HISAT2, Salmon, Kallisto, featureCounts, HTSeq)

- Differential expression & pathway enrichment (DESeq2, edgeR, GSEA, clusterProfiler)
- Metagenomic (Kraken2, MetaPhlAn, Kaiju, MEGAHIT, MetaSPAdes, Trinity, Megahit)
- Transcriptomic and Metatranscriptomic
- Exome sequencing (BWA-MEM, GATK, bcftools)
- Viral genomics - genome assembly, annotation & consensus calling (SPAdes, Minimap2, iVar, Medaka), variant calling (bcftools, GATK)
- Bayesian inference (BEAST, BEAST2), Maximum likelihood (IQ-TREE, RAxML), visualization (FigTree, iTOL), Alignment (MAFFT, MUSCLE), Phylogenomic and recombination analysis (RDP, Chimera)

Computational & Data Science Skills

- High-performance computing (HPC) environments
- Unix/Linux systems administration & shell scripting
- Command-line data processing pipelines
- Workflow development for large-scale sequencing datasets
- Containerization & reproducibility (Docker, Singularity)

Programming & Scientific Computing

- R (Advanced, ggplot2, Bioconductor)
- Python (basic)
- Bash (Advanced)
- Nextflow
- Git/GitHub

Languages

- English (proficient)
- Portuguese (Fluent)

References

1. Paolo Marinho de Andrade Zanotto, D. PHIL.

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2. Fatemeh Mosaiyebzadeh, Ph.D.

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4. Amaro Nunes Duarte Neto, MD, Ph.D.

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5. Carla Torres Braconi, Ph.D.

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6. Marielton dos Passos Cunha, Ph.D.

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7. Patrícia C. B. Beltrao-Braga, Ph.D.

Associate Professor, University of Sao Paulo, Institute of Biomedical Sciences, Department of Microbiology (ICBII), Laboratory of CNS Disease Modeling, Av. Prof Lineu Prestes, 1374, 2nd floor, room 235, Sao Paulo - SP - Brazil, Zip code: 05508-000 - Phone: +55 11 3091-7341- E-mail: patriciacbbbraga@usp.br / Scientific Platform Pasteur-USP (SPPU) InovaUSP, Universidade de Sao Paulo, Av. Prof. Lucio Martins Rodrigues 370, A-building, 4th floor, Sao Paulo - SP - Brazil, Zip code: 05508-020